

Xtreme Modding!

A Finnish man has built a PC inside a bottle of scotch whisky. Using a JREX-786LCD motherboard, Janos Marton drilled a few holes into the whisky bottle and made it a fully-functional CPU cabinet!



Sued By BitTorrent

BitTorrent recently announced that it would sue anyone using its name or trademark to distribute adware or spyware along with their P2P clients. Motion Picture Association of America (MPAA) officials were probably either too shocked or too busy laughing to respond!

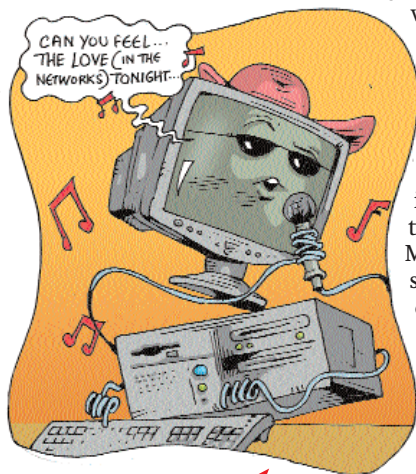


Escape

RACK-O-PHONY?

The Server Song

A team of researchers at Canada's Sheridan Institute of Technology (SIT) has done something really wacky—they've found a way to replace network traffic and statistics with music. What does that mean? We weren't sure when we stumbled across www.soundtomind.com, but



careful reading helped us understand how this idea could help change the way networks are administered.

First, a little thought: do you remember the tune that was playing in the lobby of a hotel you visited? What about the elevator you just used? Chances are you don't! That's because music can be very unobtrusive, and we're used to it

playing in the background. Sure, there are only a few genres of music that can play in the background without interrupting our thought processes—a Metallica or Megadeth song can't really be considered elevator music!

Now imagine this: if you could monitor network traffic, and see the patterns that form

when there is normal usage, and then use coding to develop soothing music for such behaviour, you have perfectly soothing background music playing when all's well with your network. Now, when there's an anomaly, an attack or an intrusion, the patterns change, as does the music. Depending on how you code the music creation from the network traffic monitoring, you could have horror movie soundtracks play when there's an intrusion!

Apparently, researchers at SIT have developed just such a system; one that sends information from a network server to an "information muSIC"(iSIC) server, which in turn converts the network traffic into algorithms. These algorithms are then passed through a synthesizer that creates the music, which is then passed on to speakers

that output the music to network administrators. In their setup, the amount of spam controls the violins, traffic between servers sits at the piano, the server load decides the drums' tempo, and chords are decided by the total number of connections to the e-mail servers.

All a network administrator has to do is train his ears to see patterns in the music, instead of staring at a screen for hours looking for intrusions. Of course, this is easier said than done, because these admins find it hard to give up staring at their screen and allowing a program to belt out a tune every time something happens!

If this idea catches on, you might soon hear murder movie soundtracks when you receive spam, or death metal when your boss sends you an e-mail! We loved the idea here at *Digit*, especially all the networking gurus, who would give anything to be able to change the way things are! Visit www.soundtomind.com for more details.

Win!

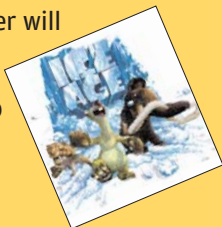
New Rules!!!

My Desktop

In response to overwhelming reader demand, we're changing the rules for 'My Desktop'. Everyone wants to know how to create their own winning desktop, so now

Next month's winner will receive a copy of

Ice Age Movie VCD



when you e-mail us, we want to know exactly how the desktop was created. As usual, no theme packs, please! Using a shell enhancement is all right, as long as you've customised it *yourself*.

Remember, if we can't recreate your desktop the way you describe it, the entry will be rejected, so please be clear!

The other rules are the same—send your desktop to mydesktop@thinkdigit.com with the subject 'My Desktop' and tell us your postal address, too.

PODSNORING

The Biggest iPod Dock Ever!

Yes, it's time for yet another crazy iPod story. Well, actually this one is an accessory, and is the largest we've come